

# PROTEIN

## DIGESTION AND ABSORPTION

### 1 MOUTH

In the mouth, chewing continues the denaturation of proteins. Unlike carbs and fats, saliva enzymes do little to digest protein.

### 2 STOMACH

Hydrochloric acid and the enzyme pepsin begin breaking proteins down into peptide chains in the stomach.

### 3 SMALL INTESTINE

In the small intestine, protease enzymes continue to break down peptide chains to single amino acids and dipeptides, which can then be absorbed into the body.

### 4 PORTAL VEIN/ LIVER / CIRCULATION

Amino acids are absorbed into the hepatic portal vein and processed through the liver into the bloodstream for use throughout the body.

